

Week 2

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Week 2 practicals

Tasks:

Step 1: Observe Default STP Behaviour

1. show spanning-tree
2. Identify the root bridge and the port that STP has placed into blocking state.

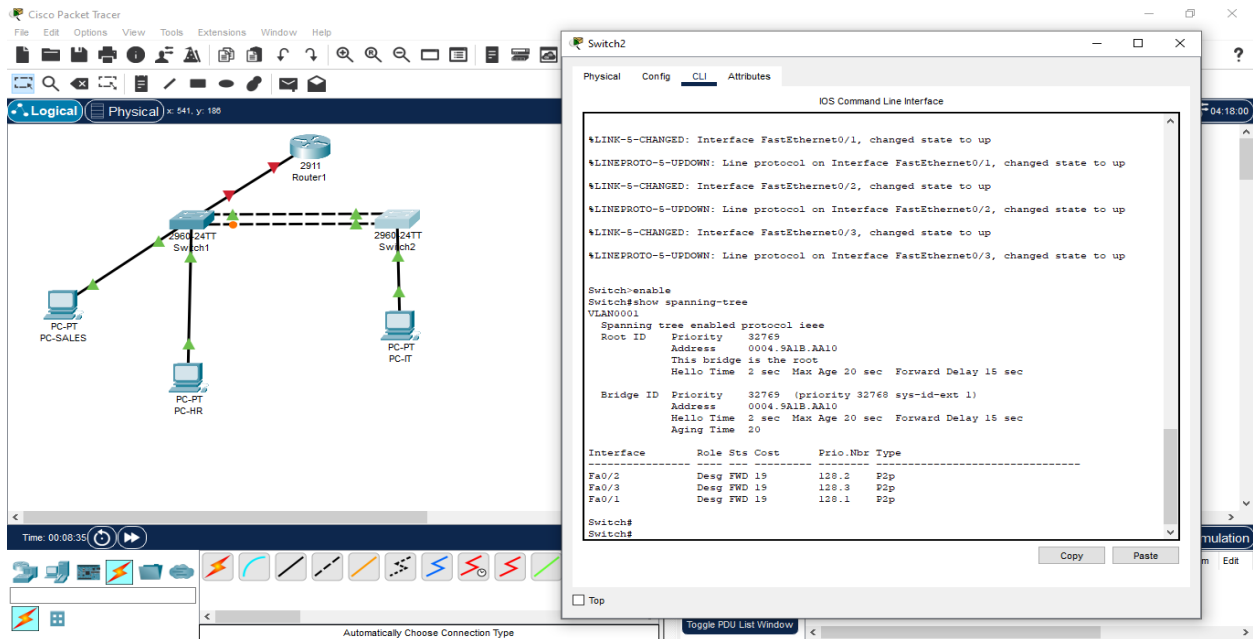
The image shows a Cisco Packet Tracer network diagram and the CLI output for Switch1. The network diagram on the left shows a topology with a 2911 Router1 connected to two 2960 24TT Switches (Switch1 and Switch2). Switch1 is connected to PC-PT PC-SALES and PC-PT PC-HR. Switch2 is connected to PC-PT PC-IT. The CLI output on the right shows the command `Switch1>show spanning-tree` and the resulting spanning tree information for VLAN0001.

```
Switch1>show spanning-tree
VLAN0001
  Spanning tree enabled protocol ieee
  Root ID    Priority    32769
             Address     0004.5A1B.AA10
             Cost        19
             Port        2 (FastEthernet0/2)
             Hello Time  2 sec  Max Age 20 sec  Forward Delay 15 sec

  Bridge ID  Priority    32769 (priority 32768 sys-id-ext 1)
             Address     0060.5C7B.64D2
             Hello Time  2 sec  Max Age 20 sec  Forward Delay 15 sec
             Aging Time  20

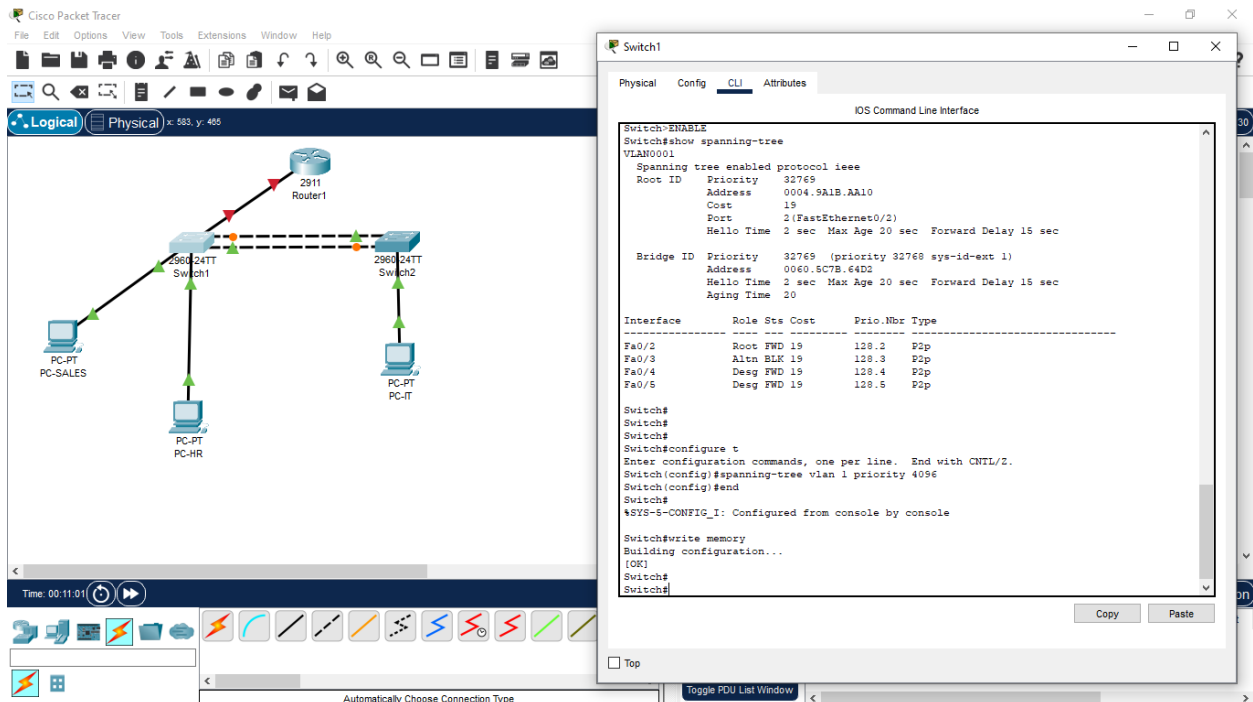
Interface Role Sts Cost Prio.Nbr Type
-----
Fa0/2 Root FWD 19 128.2 P2p
Fa0/3 Altn BLK 19 128.3 P2p
Fa0/4 Desg FWD 19 128.4 P2p
Fa0/5 Desg FWD 19 128.5 P2p
```

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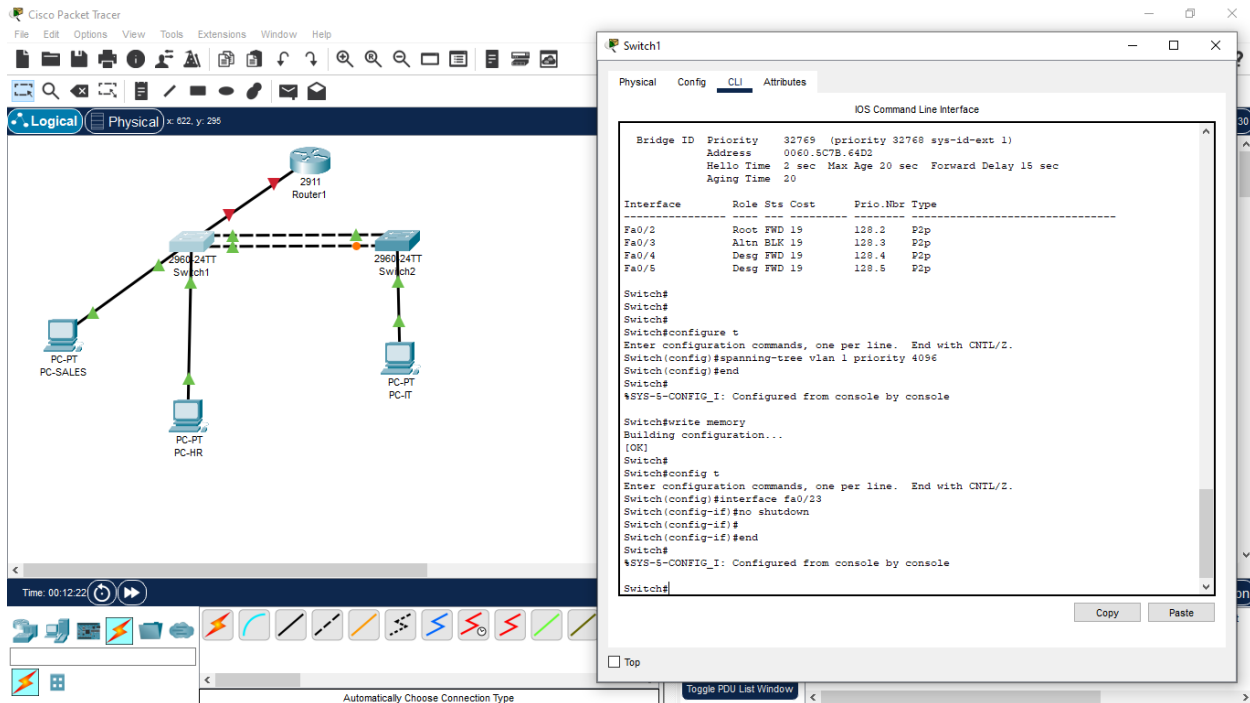


Step 2: Tune STP

1. On SW1: spanning-tree vlan 1 priority 4096 (to force SW1 as root bridge).
2. Shut down the currently active (forwarding) link between SW1 and SW2 and time how long it takes the blocked link to take over.
3. Re-enable the link once you've documented convergence.

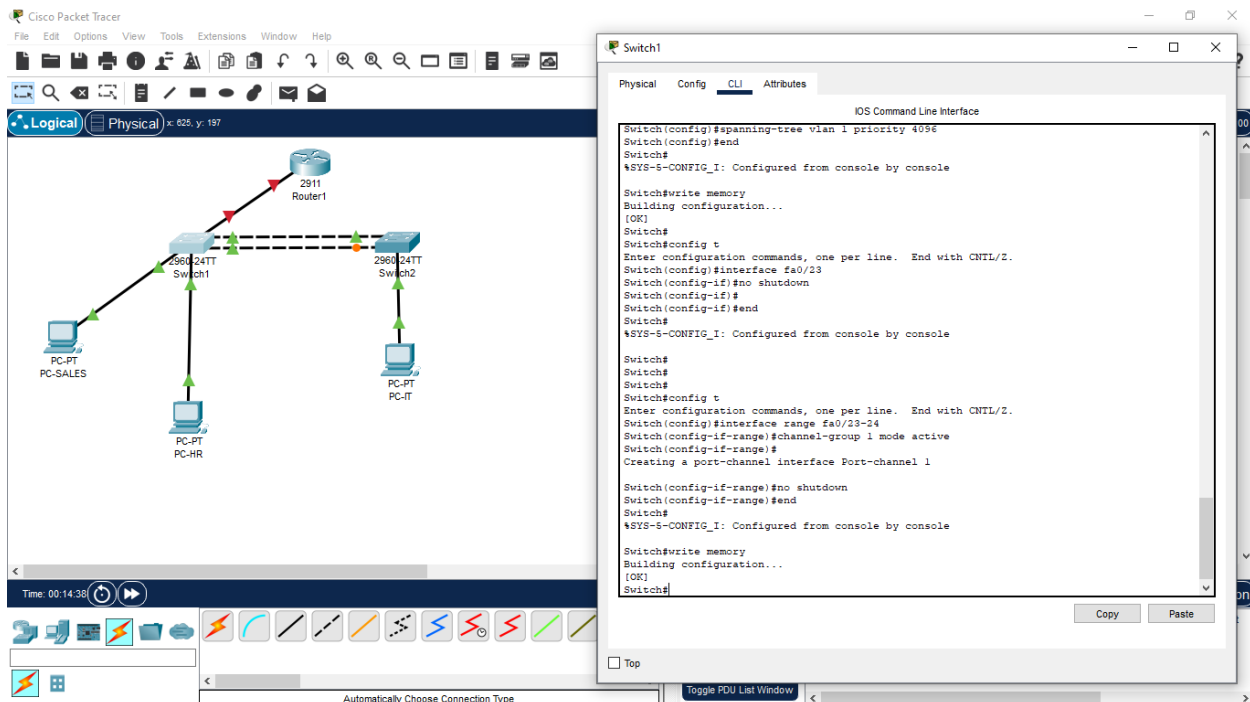


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Step 3: Replace the Redundant Links with EtherChannel

1. On both switches: interface range fa0/23-24 channel-group 1 mode active
2. show etherchannel summary



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The network diagram shows a central 2911 Router1 connected to two 2960 24TT switches, Switch1 and Switch2. Switch1 is connected to PC-SALES, PC-PT, and PC-HR. Switch2 is connected to PC-PT and PC-IT. The CLI window for Switch2 shows the following configuration:

```
Switch2
Switch2#
Switch2#
Switch2#
Switch2#config t
Enter configuration commands, one per line. End with CNTL/Z.
Switch2(config)#interface range fa0/23-24
Switch2(config-if-range)#channel-group 1 mode active
Switch2(config-if-range)#
Creating a port-channel interface Port-channel 1

Switch2(config-if-range)#no shutdown
Switch2(config-if-range)#end
Switch2#
%SYS-5-CONFIG_I: Configured from console by console

Switch2#write memory
Building configuration...
[OK]
Switch2#
Switch2#
```

Interface	Role	Sts	Cost	Prio	Nbr	Type
Fa0/2	Desg	FWD	19	128.2		P2p
Fa0/3	Desg	FWD	19	128.3		P2p
Fa0/1	Desg	FWD	19	128.1		P2p

The network diagram is identical to the one above. The CLI window for Switch1 shows the following configuration:

```
Switch1
Switch1#
Switch1#
Switch1#
Switch1#config t
Enter configuration commands, one per line. End with CNTL/Z.
Switch1(config)#interface range fa0/23-24
Switch1(config-if-range)#channel-group 1 mode active
Switch1(config-if-range)#
Creating a port-channel interface Port-channel 1

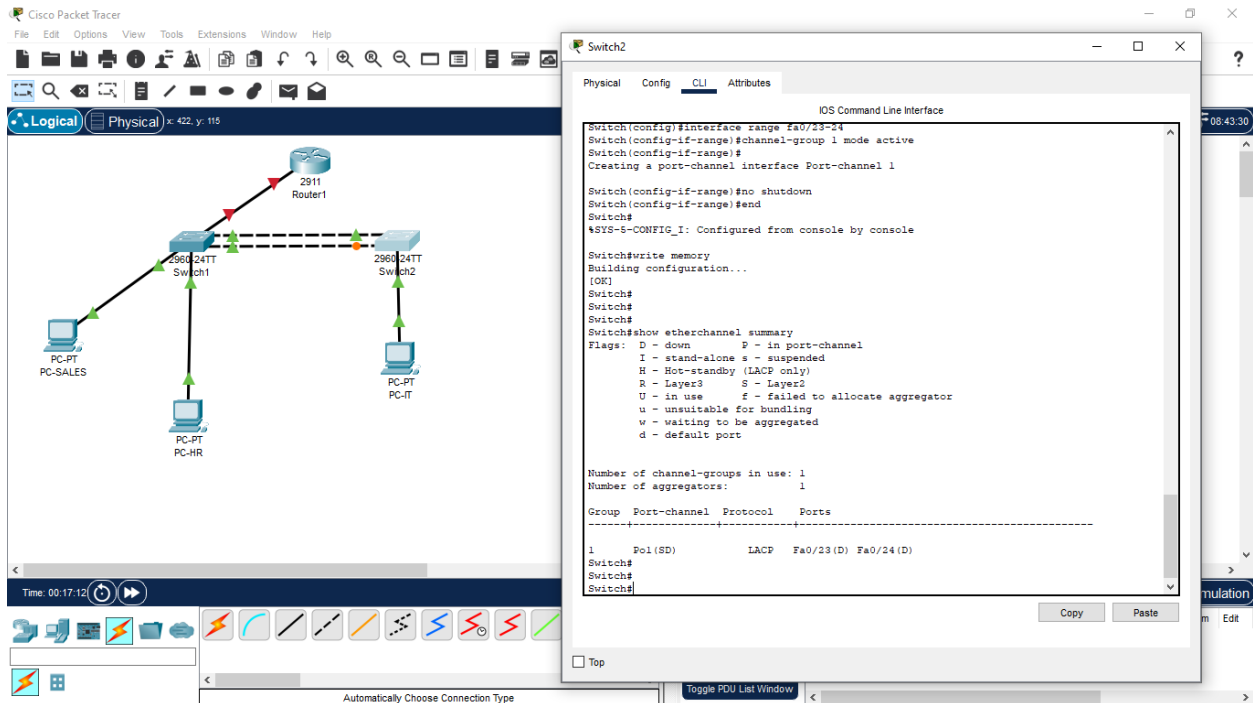
Switch1(config-if-range)#no shutdown
Switch1(config-if-range)#end
Switch1#
%SYS-5-CONFIG_I: Configured from console by console

Switch1#write memory
Building configuration...
[OK]
Switch1#
Switch1#
Switch1#show etherchannel summary
Flags: D - down P - in port-channel
I - stand-alone s - suspended
H - Hot-standby (LACP only)
R - Layer3 S - Layer2
U - in use f - failed to allocate aggregator
u - unsuitable for bundling
w - waiting to be aggregated
d - default port

Number of channel-groups in use: 1
Number of aggregators: 1

Group Port-channel Protocol Ports
-----
1 Po1(SD) LACP Fa0/23(D) Fa0/24(D)
```

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Reflection Questions (answer these in your submission):

1. What would happen to your VLAN traffic on this topology if STP were disabled entirely?

If STP is disabled with 2 physical links between SW1 and SW2, you would get a layer 2 loop.

The consequences are:

Broadcast, multicast, and unknown unicast frames loop forever between SW1 and SW2, consuming 100% bandwidth.

MAC Table Instability, switches keep seeing the same source MAC on different ports and keep updating the MAC table.

Network Meltdown, all VLAN traffic (VLAN10, VLAN20, VLAN30) would be impacted. PCs would lose connectivity.

That's why we use STP to block redundant paths, and later EtherChannel to use both links safely as one.